



Samsung LPDDR3 Chip

Samsung announced 2GB mobile memory chip with 30nm class technology claiming to transmit data at 1600Mbps per pin



UbiSlate 7 Series

Datawind launches four UbiSlate series android 4.0 devices UbiSlate 7Ri, UbiSlate 7R+, UbiSlate 7Ci and UbiSlate 7C+ from ₹2,999 to ₹4,499

Bazaar

Google Nexus 7

The best Android tablet at the moment

Now while the Apple iPad is the undisputed king as far as higher end tablets go, we have yet to see a budget Android tablet that is worth that title. Google has come out with the Nexus 7 made by ASUS as its maiden Jelly Bean (Android 4.1) sporting 7-inch tablet. As of now it is the only official Android 4.1 tablet on the market. So does the crown for the 7-inch tablets finally have a taker?

The Nexus 7 is powered by the NVIDIA Tegra 3 system-on-chip which has a quad-core processor running at 1.3GHz. It only comes in a Wi-Fi model, no 3G.

Coming in the 7-inch form-factor, the Google Nexus 7, fits quite well in the palm of your hand. The textured rubber/leather covering on the rear side, does give you that much needed grip that is lacking in many brush-metal finished tablets. At 10.4 mm thickness, the Nexus 7 is one millimeter thicker than the New Apple iPad, but the edges around the Nexus 7 are nicely beveled out.

The Nexus 7 has a backlit IPS panel and has a resolution of 1280 x 800 pixels. Not quite the retina display, but the Nexus 7 packs in a respectable 216 pixels per inch. It sports a 1.2MP front-facing camera and lacks a rear camera. Thanks to the IPS panel, the viewing angles on the Nexus 7 are fabulous, but the screen is quite reflective. Jelly Bean features Project Butter, which was meant to improve the responsiveness of the tablet. It basically makes the CPU and GPU run in parallel which gives a shot in the arm to the responsiveness of the tablet. Transitions are hap-

pening at a spiffy 60 frames per second. Jelly Bean allows you to resize your widgets. Also when you place your widget on the homescreen which already has some apps, those apps will automatically rearrange themselves to fit in the widget.

Google Now is a nifty addition to Google search. It offers contextual search based on your location. It throws up cards having the relevant information based on your location. There are various category of cards for weather, public transport, traffic, sports and so on. Getting completely used to Google Now will take a learning curve. It progressively gets better the more you use Google Search.

Notifications has undergone a sea-change. Not only do you get much more details in your notifications, but you can directly go to the app where the next action regarding the notification needs to be taken, by tapping on that particular notification. Offline Maps was one feature that has finally come on Google devices, but you have a limitation as to the area you can download – around 83 MB worth of maps can be downloaded at a time. It also supports Near-Field Communication (NFC) but due to obvious reasons it's really not that useful at the moment. But from a future-proofing perspective it is a nice addition.

With respect to performance, it is certainly less powerful than the new iPad, but that is expected. It performed at par with the ASUS Transformer Prime among the Android tablets, whereas beat most of the budget Android tablets that have been flooding the Indian market off-late.



It excels at multi-tasking. We did not notice any slowing down of the device despite opening around 10 apps, downloading stuff in the background, buffering video on YouTube and so on. NVIDIA Tegra 3 also ensures that you have a wonderful experience with graphics. Playing *Dead Trigger* was a lot of fun. The game ran smoothly without any sort of lag. With audio, at higher volumes we noticed a distortion in the sound output. We were able to overcome this issue by adjusting the equalizer settings.

The 4325 mAh battery can easily withstand 7-8 hours of regular usage.

If you want to get the best Android experience on a tablet, look no further than the Nexus 7, at the moment. Taking into consideration its US pricing, the Indian pricing is almost over ₹5,000 premium, which is a lot of money. So we would advise prospective buyers to give it time till Diwali before taking the plunge to buy the Nexus 7. Two reasons: prices will normalize and you will most likely have more tablets to compare the Nexus 7 with.

Nimish Sawant

Specifications

System-on-Chip: NVIDIA Tegra 3; **Processor:** 1.3GHz quad-core; **Screen size:** 7-inches; **Resolution:** 1280x800 pixel; **Panel:** LED Backlit IPS; **Front Camera:** 1.2MP; **Battery capacity:** 4325 mAh

Contact

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Price: USD 300 (include USD 50 for RMA) (approx. ₹16,300)

8.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance..... 8.0
Build Quality 8.0
Value for Money 8.0